

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 781

By Vital

A RESOLUTION to welcome the Trust for Public Land's national board of directors to the State of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, Trust for Public Land is a national nonprofit organization founded in 1972 and dedicated to ensuring that everyone, regardless of geography, income, or background, has access to the joys and benefits of the outdoors, and, for more than five decades, has helped protect over four million acres of land in all fifty states; and

WHEREAS, nationally, Trust for Public Land has established a distinguished legacy of conservation and community-centered planning, having created more than 5,500 parks, trails, and schoolyards; protected culturally and environmentally significant lands; and connected people to nature in ways that strengthen community health, economic opportunity, and civic life; and

WHEREAS, Trust for Public Land has been an active and trusted partner in the State of Tennessee since 1987, working collaboratively with State and local governments, community leaders, landowners, and residents to conserve land, expand public access to the outdoors, and ensure that parks and trails reflect the unique history, culture, and values of Tennessee's communities; and

WHEREAS, Trust for Public Land's impact across Tennessee includes the protection of McLean Rock, the birthplace of the Cumberland Trail, thereby preserving a critical natural and cultural landmark that anchors one of the State's most significant trail systems and contributes to Tennessee's outdoor recreation economy; and

WHEREAS, since 1994, Trust for Public Land has played a pivotal role in securing land for and the planning and funding of the Tennessee Riverpark and Riverwalk in Chattanooga, a signature public space that helped catalyze the city's outdoor and economic renaissance by

supporting tourism, attracting private investment, and reconnecting residents and visitors to the Tennessee River; and

WHEREAS, Trust for Public Land has also helped protect ecologically and economically important landscapes along the Mississippi River, including the Chickasaw National Wildlife Refuge, thereby safeguarding one of the largest remaining bottomland hardwood forests in the region for wildlife habitat, outdoor recreation, and long-term public benefit; and

WHEREAS, through its work across urban neighborhoods, rural communities, and natural landscapes, Trust for Public Land has expanded access to parks and green spaces for more than 30,000 Tennesseans; protected working lands and waterways; and supported more than eighty outdoor projects that strengthen local economies, improve public health, and enhance Tennessee's quality of life; and

WHEREAS, the Trust for Public Land's national board of directors provides strategic leadership and stewardship in advancing the organization's mission, guiding its national direction, and supporting partnerships that translate community vision into lasting public assets; and

WHEREAS, the visit of the Trust for Public Land's national board to Tennessee marks the organization's first board convening in the State in twenty-five years, offering a meaningful opportunity to recognize past accomplishments, strengthen partnerships, and explore future opportunities aligned with Tennessee's growth, conservation priorities, and community aspirations; and

WHEREAS, the State of Tennessee and Trust for Public Land share a strong and enduring commitment to conserving the State's natural heritage, expanding access to outdoor recreation, and ensuring that parks, trails, and public lands continue to serve as drivers of health, economic vitality, and community connection; and

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly are pleased to recognize and commend Trust for Public Land for its national legacy, its transformative impact across Tennessee, and its shared vision with the State of Tennessee to connect everyone to the joys and benefits of the outdoors, now and for generations to come; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we extend a warm welcome to the Trust for Public Land's national board of directors and staff leadership as they convene in the State of Tennessee, expressing our sincere appreciation for their decades of bipartisan leadership, partnership, and investment in the people, places, and landscapes of the Volunteer State.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.